

Colourmap — Vision & Growth

A consolidated map of where this app is going — assembled from the specs and conversations of the last few weeks. Not a feature list. A theory of why, then the shape of how, then a concrete what next.

What's in this document

1. The thesis — what we are actually building
2. The five surfaces — Day, Music, Notebook, Circles, Overview
3. The Music story — Chill ↔ Groove unity, 7 soundscapes, deep bass, atmospheres
4. The Social story — Circles, salons, parties, venues
5. The Overview story — progression, beauty, ethical gamification
6. Design system + adaptive direction
7. Growth strategy — €0-budget social media (salons → nights → festivals)
8. The 90-day plan — what ships first
9. Risks & honest tradeoffs

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1 · The thesis

*Colourmap is a place where **people who already love each other** tend to their inner lives and make things together — calmly, beautifully, without performing for strangers.*

It's not a productivity app, not a meditation app, not a music app, not a social network — although it touches all four. It's the *connective tissue* between an artist's solo work, their close circle, and the rooms they show up in.

The bet underneath every decision: a generation of late-20s-to-40s urban creatives is exhausted by platforms that optimize for engagement and ad spend. They want a small intentional space that holds their music, their weekly check-ins, their band, their salon — without selling them content or comparing them to strangers.

*We are building **Patagonia of social**, not Meta. Smaller, more honest, more sustainable. Ceiling: 5–50M users globally paying €5–10/month with deep retention. Not a billion users; never going for that.*

The five core human needs current platforms don't deliver

Need	Current platforms give	What's missing
Belonging — "I have a group"	Algorithmic feed of strangers	Real small-group presence
Expression — "I made something"	Performance for likes	Witness without audit
Witness — "someone sees me"	Vanity metrics	Quiet attention
Connection — "I know you"	DMs that decay	Persistent gentle threads
Tribe — "we share something"	Hashtags / fandoms	Active making together

Three founding principles

1. **Small-group first, public-feed never.** No global feed. Activity visible only to your Circles. Default = private.
2. **Time-bound, not permanent.** Check-ins live for the day. Posts decay. Party Circles last a week. Permanence is a bug; it forces you to perform for an imagined future audience.
3. **Making together, not posting alone.** The unit of social action shifts from "post" → "co-create." Songs made with friends. Groove sessions. Synchronized check-ins.

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2 · The five surfaces

Colourmap is small on purpose. Five surfaces, no more.

● Day

WHERE YOU CHECK IN WITH YOURSELF

The cockpit. Two big dots — **Feeling** and **Doing** — open into 60-second guided check-ins. Captures tone, energy, current objective, what you're working on. Twice a day at most. The base layer everything else reads from.

● Music

HOW YOU SET YOUR INNER WEATHER

Two tools, one engine. **Chill Machine** = atmosphere creator (binaural drone, sacred frequencies, layered field-recording soundscapes, melodic instruments). **Groove Machine** = generative beat box that consumes atmospheres from Chill as backgrounds and adds rhythm + chord motion. 7 curated soundscapes (Tech House → Lofi Rooftop) cover the full mood spectrum.

● Notebook

WHERE THE INNER LIFE LEAVES A TRACE

Lightweight markdown-flavoured note-taking with multiple notebooks (Notes, Ideas, Journal, Songs, Projects, Rhymes, Practice, Lessons). Per-note typography + colour. AI helpers for songwriting (chorus, verse, chords, bridge). Saved sound moments from Chill and Groove auto-land here.

● Circles

A SHARED SPACE TO ALIGN MISSIONS AND BECOME EFFECTIVE IN THE PROCESS

The social primitive. 5–30 people who share a context (band, friend group, coworking space, party, retreat). No follow, no feed, no public profile. Activity inside a Circle: each member's daily check-in (compass colour visible), shared

missions with owners + due dates, low-volume notes, presence indicator. *The first real test will be running our own band's project on it.*

● Overview

WHERE YOU SEE THE SHAPE OF WHO YOU'VE BEEN

The reflective surface. Seven layers: **Now Bar** (one calm sentence summarizing the present) → **Week Shape** (heat-river of feeling + doing across 7 days) → **Compass flower** (4-axis radar of inner / doing / care / play balance) → **Track Lines** (dots-per-pursuit momentum view) → **Soundscape Garden** (constellation of where you've been musically) → **Quiet Notes** (random old fragment surfaced) → **Slow Wins** (gentle milestones quietly noticed).

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3 · The Music story

Chill Machine — atmosphere

The atmosphere creator. Five layer categories (Waters / Birds & Forest / Drones & Voices / Textures / Digital). Real instruments scrolling strip (piano, violin, cello, flute, harp, etc., all CCo sample packs). Wave visualization that reacts to active layers. Effects (wah, echo) on the melody chain. Per-slider colour progressions. Tunes melodies to context (the user's chosen base frequency).

Coming: a deep-bass / shamanic family — didgeridoo, throat singing, Tibetan gong, slow LFO sub-bass. "Shamanic dubstep" — chest-pressure low end at heart-rate tempo. Differentiates the calm side from every other meditation app on the market.

Groove Machine — rhythm + motion

15-voice generative beat box with 4 dynamics modes (Full / Breakdown / Drop / Silence) + Randomize. **7 curated soundscapes**, each its own bpm + swing + pattern + chord progression + voice palette:

Preset	BPM	References
Sun-up Funk	112	Daft Punk · Jamiroquai · golden hour
Tech House	124	Berlin late-night · Kompakt
Tropical	104	Kygo sunset · steel pan + marimba
Slow Roll	78	R&B bedroom soul
Boom Bap	90	Biggie · Nas · J Dilla · 1995
Epic Electro	126	Justice · Discovery · Madeon
Lofi Rooftop	82	Nujabes · J Dilla · study beats

Big-dot picker UI. Tap a dot → engine reconfigures. Long term: bar-aligned tempo+key-matched cross-fades so the wandering between them feels like one continuous piece.

The unity — Chill as atmosphere for Groove

Chill stays Chill (atmosphere creator). Groove gains an **Atmosphere** strip that consumes saved soundscapes from Chill and plays them as the bed under the rhythm. Two tools, one shared sound library (`lib/sound-library.ts`). The unity is plumbing, not UI — Chill builders' atmospheres flow into Groove sessions automatically.

Long-term — calm ↔ fire blend arcs + collective control

A session becomes a sequence of moods (e.g. *calm 4m* → *rising 1m* → *groove 5m* → *drop 15s* → *groove 4m* → *breakdown 1m* → *return to calm 3m*). Pre-built arcs: *Sunrise*, *Workout*, *Long focus*, *Party*, *Free*. Music isn't always intense — silence and breathing are first-class.

In Circle mode, three collective-control modes:

- **Vote axis** — every phone has one calm↔fire slider; room takes the average.
- **Solo rotation** — one person gets full DJ for 3 minutes, then it rotates.
- **Team-of-3** — a trio shares control (mood / layer / intensity), forced collaboration.

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4 · *The Social story*

Circles — the building block

5–30 people sharing a context. No follow. No feed. No public profile. Types:

- **Persistent personal** — your band, close friends, weekly meditation group.
- **Event Circles** — last 7 days for a salon / party / retreat. Auto-archive.
- **Coworking Circles** — same data, different mode. Quiets at session end.
- **Venue Circles** — temporary 3-hour Circle for everyone checked into a partnered bar / café.

Profile — anti-LinkedIn

ML Martin Lenweiter

musician · designer · Paris

◆ today's compass · easing / focus

◆ what I'm building · Colourmap

◆ what I'm listening to · Kitchen Light loop #3

links · soundcloud · instagram · website · email

The status updates daily, driven by morning compass. Links are stable. People meet you *in time* (right now I'm in this state), not in static identity.

The party scenario — 20–30 people downloading at the door

Three reasons people actually pull out their phone at a party:

1. **The music belongs to me too.** Without the app you're a passive listener. With it you tap a button and the room's mix shifts.
2. **The exit ticket is in your pocket.** Each guest gets a 90-second souvenir — their two minutes of "having the wheel" + names of everyone who was there. Only via the app.
3. **Your tribe is here, not on Instagram.** Tonight, the people in this room are the network. The app holds the small Circle of people you actually met.

Venue partnerships

Curated bars / cafés / cowork spots become nodes on the Colourmap map. Each shows: how many users currently checked in, the room's "vibe" (aggregate compass state), what's playing. Foot traffic on slow Tuesdays. Curated Colourmap nights monthly. Revenue: €100–300/mo per venue + 80/20 split on curated event door donations.

Aesthetic safeguard: independent natural-wine bars, bookshop-cafés, creative coworking spots, small concert venues. *If the venue would put a Coca-Cola sticker in their window, it's not a Colourmap venue.*

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5 · The Overview story

Open the app on a Sunday morning. Before you tap anything, you see what your week was. Not as numbers — as a shape. The shape is recognizable: it looks like your week. You feel a small yes, that was me.

Three feelings to evoke

1. **Recognition** — that's me.
2. **Beauty** — I want to keep looking at this.
3. **Insight** — I learned something I didn't know.

The seven layers (top to bottom)

1. **Now Bar** — one sentence summarizing the present moment. Generated locally.
2. **Week Shape** — horizontal heat-river of feeling + doing across 7 days. The visible streak. No counters.
3. **Compass flower** — 4-axis radar (Inner / Doing / Care / Play). Petals bloom or wilt based on the past 14 days.
4. **Track Lines** — horizontal lines, one per pursuit (project, song, habit). Each ● = a session. Faded trailing dots = momentum slipping.
5. **Soundscape Garden** — constellation of soundscapes you've touched. Dots pulse with time spent. Tap to re-enter.
6. **Quiet Notes** — randomly-rotated fragment from your old notes. The Memory layer.

7. **Slow Wins** — gentle milestones surfaced after the fact. *"You've checked in 30 days in a row." "Your evening sessions are getting longer."*

The ethical gamification stance

What we DON'T do: points, levels, leaderboards, streak warnings, badges, notifications-to-engagement. The bet: people are intrinsically motivated by **seeing themselves**, not by points. Especially this audience.

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6 · Design system + adaptive direction

Today the codebase has a *direction* (warm earth palette, serif/handwritten typography, soft borders) but not yet a *system*. Every component reinvents spacing / font-size / colour. That's why every cockpit polish iteration takes another round.

The fix — two threads in parallel

1. **Lift design decisions into tokens.** A handful of typed constants in `lib/design-tokens.ts` for space / `fontSize` / colours / radii / touch. Adopted per-touch, no rewrite.
2. **Move from breakpoint-based to context-based adaptation.** Container queries + viewport units + a real `useViewport()` hook. `100dvh` for cockpit so iOS Safari address-bar collapse stops jumping the layout.

Three target classes

Class	What changes
Phone ($\leq 600\text{px}$)	Single column · text 15–16px base · touch 44×44 · safe-area-inset on every fixed element
Tablet (601–1024px)	2-column where desktop has 3 · drawer-style sub-panels · touch-first
Desktop (1025px+)	Multi-column · hover affordances · keyboard shortcuts visible · cap at ~1400px

7 · Growth strategy — €0-budget social media

The cheapest customer acquisition is people who already love each other in the same room. Build for that. Resist every temptation to scale it any way that removes the room.

Four stages, each self-funded

1. **The Salon (months 0–3, 6–12 people)** — single small evening in a single living room. The app guides 90 minutes (check-in, music, reflection). Marginal cost per attendee = €0. 70% of guests tell 2 friends within a week.
2. **The Underground Night (months 3–9, 30–80 people)** — monthly venue evening. Donation door covers venue. Out-of-pocket from us = €0.
3. **Experiments + Expos (months 6–18)** — strange-enough things people *want to write about*: 24-hour Salon, Silent Salon, Cooking Salon, Gallery Night, Co-living week. Stories travel. Press is free.
4. **Festivals (months 12–24)** — small art festival or design week installations. The festival pays the booth. Press in design + art outlets.

What we never do

- Paid ads (Google / Meta / TikTok)
- Influencer partnerships
- Hire a marketer (founders are the marketers until ~100k MAU)
- PR firms
- Conferences as attendees (only as exhibitors with a free booth)

90-day cost projection

Total spend: **under €500**. Reach: plausibly **200–400 people in the app**, all of whom touched it through someone they trusted.

8 · *The 90-day plan*

Concrete shipping order. Each item is half a day to a few days.

Now (in flight)

- NowBar component at top of Overview tab
- LifeCategoriesStrip — slidable big-dot life map
- Feeling/Doing palette picker (10 curated colour pairs)
- Groove Machine 7 soundscapes catalogue + big-dot picker
- Wider AppShell + bigger objective inputs
- Save-this-moment → Notebook from Chill + Groove

Month 1

- Circle Missions schema + UI (the band test)
- Compass-colour avatar ring on Circle members
- "What else I'm working on" tile
- Sound library extraction (lib/sound-library.ts)
- Atmosphere strip in Groove Machine

Month 2

- SoundSessionProvider + global mini-player
- Salon Mode preset (host-flow with sequenced surfaces)
- Run Salon #1 with our own friends
- Deep-bass / shamanic Chill layer family
- Overview Layer 2 — Week Shape (heat-river)

Month 3

- Compass flower (Layer 3)
- Track Lines (Layer 4)
- Salons #2–#5 across 5 cities (recruit hosts)
- Underground Night #1 in our city
- Profile page (compass colour + 3 links + one-sentence)

9 · Risks and honest tradeoffs

Risk	What we accept
Small forever	Ceiling: 5–50M globally paying €5–10/mo. Patagonia of social, not Meta. More sustainable, less spectacular, more honest.
Slow to acquire	Without a public feed, virality is muted. 6–12 months to 10k users. Word-of-mouth + events.
Venue ops are hard	Partnership management, dead-Tuesday nights, bad weather. Operational rigour required.
Privacy / GDPR	Proximity-based meeting needs careful opt-in. Legal layer matters.
Aesthetic policing	"No Coca-Cola venues" sounds elitist. Need careful press framing.
Founder taste risk	Vision is musician-led. If Martin steps back, curation collapses. Need succession plan year 2+.

Closing

Wake up alone → check in → quiet music → Circle of friends sees your colour today → coworking session → evening event → 90-second souvenir → tomorrow morning, a friend from the event is now in your Circle.

That's the loop the app holds. None of the existing platforms hold this loop. The work for the next 90 days is closing the gaps in that loop, one PR at a time, in our own band's living room first.

Colourmap · From organization to clarity.

Master vision document, written 2026-04-25 · consolidates ~15 individual specs

Created by Vikash and Martin